Employee Leave Policy

1. Purpose and Scope

This policy explains the types of leave available to employees of Northwind Labs and how to request them. It applies to all full-time employees and takes effect on 1 January 2026. Part-time employees receive leave in proportion to their contracted hours.

Managers must apply this policy consistently. Questions about eligibility should be sent to the People Team at people@northwind.example before leave is booked.

2. Annual Leave

Every full-time employee is entitled to 24 paid days of annual leave per calendar year. Leave accrues at 2 days for each completed month of service, so new joiners receive a pro-rated entitlement.

Employees may carry forward a maximum of 10 unused days into the next year. Carried-forward days must be used by 31 March, after which they expire without compensation.

Requests for 5 or more consecutive working days must be submitted at least 14 days in advance. Shorter requests need 2 working days notice. All annual leave needs written approval from the line manager.

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3. Sick Leave

Employees receive 12 paid sick days per year. Sick days do not carry forward. The employee must inform their manager before 10:00 AM on the first day of absence.

A medical certificate is required when the absence lasts more than 2 consecutive days. Repeated short absences may be reviewed with the People Team in a supportive conversation.

4. Parental Leave

Maternity leave is 26 weeks, paid at 100 percent of base salary. Paternity leave is 4 weeks, paid at 100 percent of base salary and may be taken within 6 months of the birth.

Adoption leave is 12 weeks, paid at 100 percent of base salary. Employees must notify the People Team at least 8 weeks before the expected start date, except in cases of early birth or placement.

During parental leave the company continues health insurance contributions. Annual leave continues to accrue while an employee is on maternity, paternity or adoption leave.

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5. Leave Entitlement Summary

The table below summarises paid entitlements, notice periods and documentation requirements.

Leave type	Paid days per year	Notice required	Documentation
Annual leave	24	14 days (for 5+ days)	None
Sick leave	12	Before 10:00 AM same day	Certificate after 2 days
Casual leave	6	1 working day	None
Bereavement leave	5	As soon as possible	None
Study leave	10	30 days	Proof of enrolment

6. Public Holidays

Northwind Labs observes 12 public holidays each year. The full list is published by the People Team every December for the following year. If a public holiday falls inside an annual leave period it is not deducted from the leave balance.

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7. Unpaid Leave

In exceptional circumstances an employee may request unpaid leave of up to 90 days. Unpaid leave needs the approval of the department director and is not available during the first 6 months of employment.

8. Leave Encashment

When employment ends, up to 10 unused annual leave days are paid out at the employee's basic daily rate. Sick leave and casual leave cannot be encashed.

9. Contacts

For questions about this policy write to people@northwind.example or visit the People Team desk on the third floor. Urgent requests outside working hours can be sent to the on-call manager.

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